



Balancing Network Security Risks

A CISO's Guide

Being a CISO in today's world is filled with risk. From the shift to remote work to the increasing threat landscape, CISOs are constantly faced with new challenges when it comes to securing their corporate networks.

During the third quarter of 2022 alone, internet users worldwide saw approximately 15 million data breaches, up by 167 percent compared to the previous quarter.* © Statista 2022

Attack methods are getting more sophisticated at the same time that more and more employees are connecting remotely—a scenario where security solutions can easily multiply and become complicated to manage, making a CISO's job all the more stressful.

With so many dynamic challenges, it can be difficult to prioritize and implement the essential steps for comprehensive network security. Here are the top five network security practices every CISO needs to know in order to keep their security ship afloat—and keep their jobs.

Ensure Consistent Visibility and Control

Managing several independent security platforms is a CISO's nightmare. Without a single converged platform, it's difficult to monitor multiple dashboards and track activity across several applications. That's why choosing a converged solution that brings multiple security tools together is a major step to increasing overall network management and daily monitoring, all while reducing network risks.

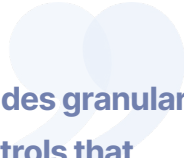
By relying on a single platform, CISOs can deploy, configure, manage, and monitor the state of their network in order to be aware of any suspicious activity or threats as they arise. Managing features such as [Zero Trust Network Access \(ZTNA\)](#), [Firewall as a Service \(FWaaS\)](#), and [Secure Web Gateway \(SWG\)](#) all in one pane of glass allows simpler deployment and monitoring, without compromising any essential security implementations.

Get Armed With Zero Trust Network Access

As companies adjust to more employees working from home, the increased potential for compromised employee credentials and malicious attempts to infiltrate corporate networks creates the risk of unauthorized actors obtaining confidential information from your business.

Legacy VPNs of the past don't address today's need for secure remote access, leaving organizations vulnerable to security breaches. A business VPN gives users within the organization permission to access the entire internal network meaning one bad actor can infiltrate multiple company resources through one weak link. Hardware VPNs are also complex to configure making it difficult to restrict users and devices from accessing specific applications.

Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA), however, allows companies to easily segment user permissions to allow employees access only to the resources they need. With granular access controls, security risks are significantly decreased as the attack surface becomes limited. A comprehensive ZTNA solution should also make sure to hide all resources' external IP addresses, keeping your resources safe as hackers can't attack what they cannot see.



ZTNA provides granular access controls that limit the attack surface

Isolate Resources With Agentless Access

There are many ways the attack surface of an organization can grow such as providing access to third-party contractors or making accommodations for employees on unmanaged devices. These conveniences may make day-to-day operations more efficient, but it also makes it harder to prevent dangerous threats from sneaking in. That's why finding a secure solution for enabling agentless access is on top of every CISO's list of must-haves.

By implementing agentless Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA), agentless users are able to securely access specific applications based on their permissions. Employees using a device without a client can access applications using the HTTPS, RDP, VNC, and SSH protocols via browser.

With agentless ZTNA, users are only given access to specific apps, not the wider network. Users' application access is tracked and limited according to rules that use criteria like location, time, browser, OS, device, and more, making agentless ZTNA an essential part of a CISO's security toolkit.

CISOs should also implement two-factor authentication along with agentless ZTNA to ensure that networks and resources are protected from a wide range of attacks and vulnerabilities. As well, finding an agentless ZTNA provider with easy monitoring and tracking allows CISOs to keep an eye on the activity of third-party contractors across all their resources.



Two-factor authentication and agentless ZTNA help ensure that networks are protected from threats.

Establish Safety in the Cloud

As more companies rely on cloud-based business applications, it's key that CISOs protect all cloud-based applications from unauthorized access. Allowing access to resources from only a limited list of pre-approved IP addresses greatly reduces the cloud attack surface.

Utilizing a cloud security service which provides dedicated static IP addresses enables this. On top of that, adding secure tunnels between users and gateways allows an essential layer of protection for the entire network.

By enforcing strict policies on resource and data access in the cloud, CISOs can help prevent the next breach and potential loss of critical data.

Prevent data loss and unauthorized access by enforcing strict access policies on data in the cloud.

Compliance is Key

CISOs must adhere to the highest standards of software security compliance so they can rest assured their organization's data remains fully protected.

Here are a few critical ways CISOs can stay compliant under government laws:



GDPR - Follow GDPR compliance by encrypting data, providing access to data in a timely manner following a physical or technical incident and ensuring confidentiality, integrity, availability and resilience of systems.



HIPAA - Avoid using open public networks to do corporate work. If the connection is unsecured, employees risk exposing their practice to large HIPAA-related fines, as well as having the network invaded by intruders.



SOC 2 Type 2 - You can get the assurance you need by finding a platform with a SOC 2 Type 2 compliance badge, promising you honest security and privacy through the cloud, on-premises, and hybrid environments.



ISO 27001 & 27002 - Go beyond the requirements and seek a platform with these two additional standards of information security systems and processes. Solutions abiding by ISO 27001 & 27002 compliance confirm they meet the highest level of risk assessment and management.

There are no shortcuts when it comes to security compliance, but taking the right steps is sure to pay off in the long run as your organization gears up to cover all of its security needs.

Perimeter 81 for CISOs

With Perimeter 81, CISOs can trust their IT teams to create, manage and monitor the company's network from a unified platform.



The all-in-one solution

From Zero Trust Network Access (ZTNA) to Secure Web Gateway (SWG), CISOs can arm their teams with a complete security kit all in a single platform. The converged Perimeter 81 solution is managed from a single-pane-of-glass console, making it easy to monitor, assess and respond to any potential threats.



Complete visibility and monitoring

With detailed data reports, your team can fully monitor and secure your most valuable resources by identifying unusual activity and analyzing network trends.



Covering all the bases

Perimeter 81 enables both agent and agentless access to users, allowing IT to rest assured that their resources are protected whenever granting permissions to users in and out of the organization.



Security compliance

Perimeter 81 meets the highest standard of compliance, following GDPR, HIPAA, SOC 2 Type 2, and ISO 27001 & 27002 compliance regulations to ensure your organization's data is fully protected.



Secure user connections

By integrating with major identity providers, Perimeter 81 makes it easy to implement **Multi-Factor Authentication** and Single-Sign-On, allowing users to safely connect to the network with passwordless authentication.



Safer browsing

Perimeter 81's **Automatic Wi-Fi** security solution activates VPN protection when employees connect to unknown networks. Our client automatically routes all connections through our secure servers anytime users connect to unsecured Wi-Fi, with no manual steps required.



Added layer of security

Our **Device Posture Check** inspects employee devices for the presence of antivirus software, disk encryption, certificates and specific files or processes, preventing potentially dangerous devices from connecting.



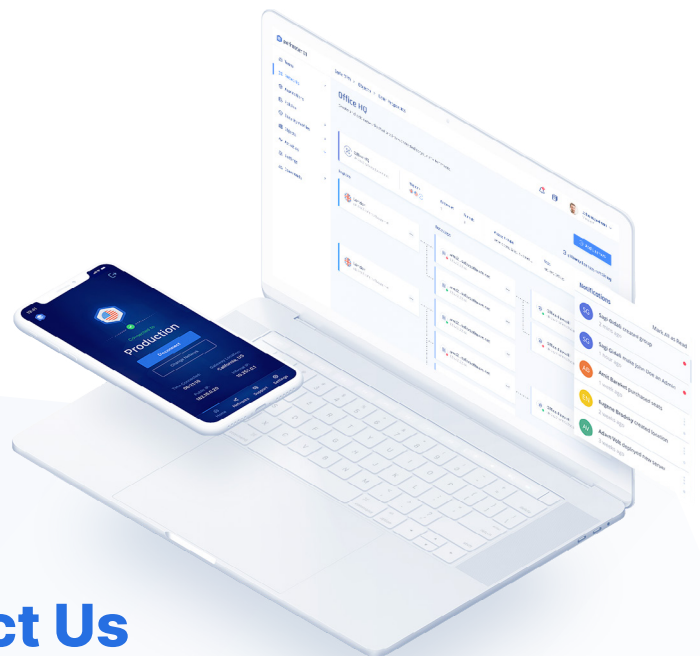
Scale as you grow

With more than 40 global PoPs, Perimeter 81 allows you to scale quickly and effortlessly, adding networks and gateways without limits.

Keep your employees and resources safe with Perimeter 81's cloud-native network security solution. With instant deployment, compliance support, and seamless integrations to all major cloud providers, Perimeter 81 is a CISO's best bet for keeping their networks safe and their jobs off the hook.

About Perimeter 81

Perimeter 81 is a robust, yet easy-to-use, converged networking and network security platform which connects all users, in the office or remote, to all resources, located on-prem, or clouds. It is a cloud-native service that includes advanced capabilities such as Zero Trust remote access, Internet access control, malware protection and firewall as a service. It enables any business to build a secure corporate network over a private global backbone, without hardware and within minutes. The entire service is managed from a unified console and is backed by an award-winning global support team that has you covered 24/7.



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